

Expense Tracker MCP

Talk to your money. It lives in a CSV on your laptop.

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The problem

1

Tedious

Logging every coffee by hand is boring, so people stop after a week.

2

Invasive

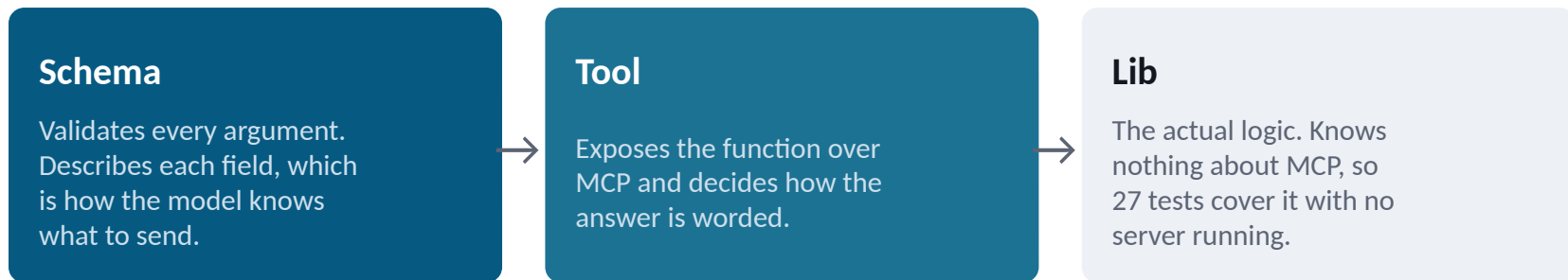
The apps that fix that want your bank login and a subscription.

3

Offline

Mine keeps the data in a CSV you own. No account, no keys, no network.

Three layers, one job each



Bad input dies at the schema — the handler never runs and the file is never touched.

prompt → schema → tool → lib → expenses.csv

Six tools, two resources

<code>add_expense</code>	Saves an expense, returns it with a new id
<code>list_expenses</code>	Filtered by month or category, capped and paged
<code>get_spending_summary</code>	Monthly total with a per-category breakdown
<code>list_categories</code>	Every category present in the data
<code>delete_expense</code>	Removes one expense by id, never by row position
<code>get_top_expenses</code>	The largest expenses, optionally for one month

Plus `expenses://fixture` and `expenses://categories` — read-only context, no tool call needed.

What's next

SQLite

Same tools, different storage — it all sits behind one file.

Budgets

Warn when a category goes over its monthly limit.

Comparison

This month against last, so the trend is visible.

A peer found that a note containing a comma silently corrupted a row.

Everything looked fine until someone tried the input I hadn't. It's the first unit test now.